Indiana Economic Development Corp®

SSI PROGRAM

# Indiana Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program



## Executive Team Briefing

November 10, 2026

Prepared by Location Design Group, LLC
(formerly Leotta Location and Design)

LOCATION Design Group

# What Indiana already owns

**1,811**
greenfield sites, all 92 counties

**235,402**
acres

**74**
counties ranked in local workshops

**490**
sites ranked 4.0 or higher

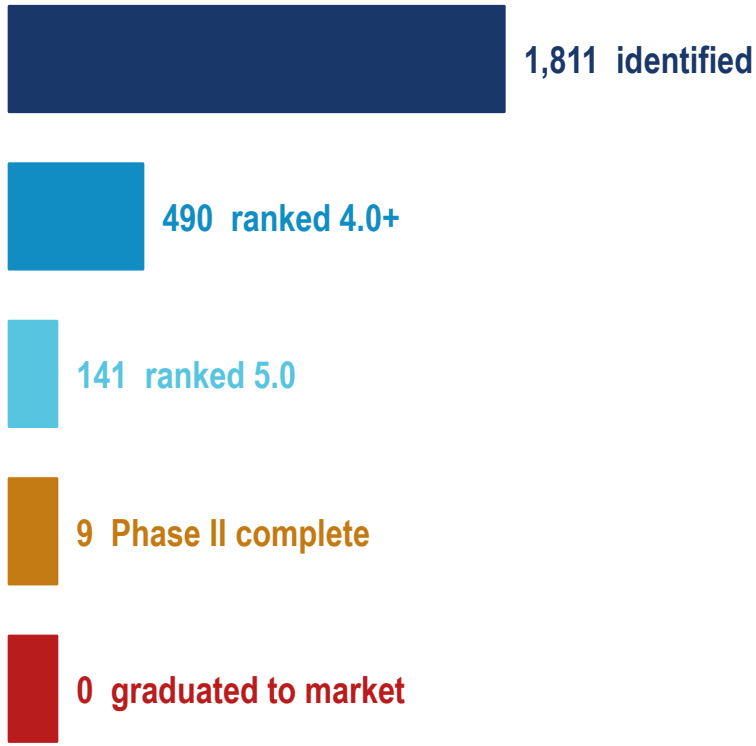
**141**
sites ranked 5.0

**70**
potential mega sites

**$1.39M over seven years. $1.21M of it IEDC's, three agreements, six signatories, two administrations.**

LEAP sits on an SSI-certified site by IEDC's own description. $23B+ announced there since 2022.

IDENTIFICATION TO GRADUATION




***Identification without graduation is a map, not a product.***

# The market moved to site readiness

**61%**

of site selectors: development-ready site availability is the #1 elimination factor

**+20 pts**

one-year jump in the weight of readiness and due diligence status

**27**

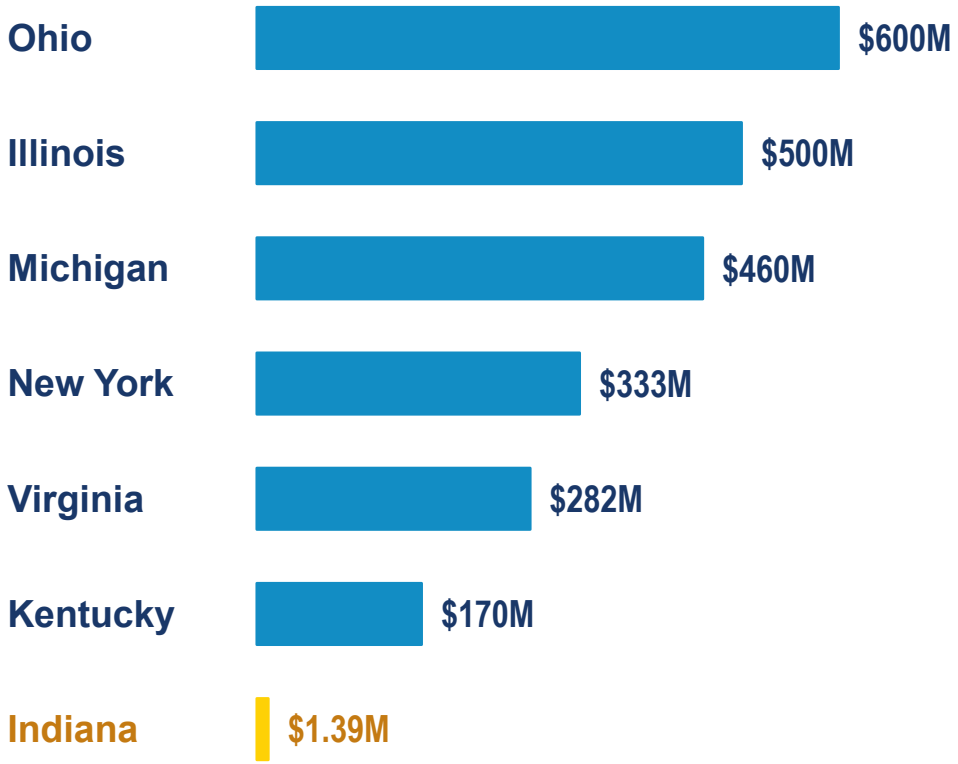
states now fund site readiness

**<10**

sites over 250 acres left in Virginia after $282M and a string of wins

*Sources: Site Selectors Guild and DCI, March 2026; Area Development, 2026; Virginia Business, January 2024.*

SITE READINESS FUNDING BY STATE SINCE 2022




**Peer states pay to find and qualify sites. Indiana has paid for the finding. Graduation is the step not yet funded.**

# Indiana's policies and drivers: what the program answers

## GOVERNOR'S OFFICE AND GENERAL ASSEMBLY

### Region-led planning, EO 25-45
15 regions, each with a growth plan

### Wage standard, EO 25-44
County average wage as the incentive floor

### CIRDA and the $1B life sciences initiative
100,000 jobs at 125% of county wage

### HEA 1406 redevelopment credits
$35M a year against a ranked development plan

## IEDC

### Sites that are held, ready, and marketable
REDOs lack the time and the playbook

### Defense, life sciences, pharmaceuticals
Sector-specific site requirements

### Data centers communities will accept
50+ counties restricting; large tracts absorbed

### Lower-cost, targeted incentives
A controlled site is the cheapest incentive

### Everyday RFI response and expansion
Portal, NAICS search, existing-business growth

# Where the program stands

## DONE

- All 92 counties searched twice
- 74 counties ranked in workshops
- Nine portals, 107 sub-licenses

## STARTED

- Phase II on 9 sites, utility funded
- 24 sites nominated, unfunded
- Phase III method drafted, 2026 edition

## NOT STARTED

- No site taken to a purchase option
- No NAICS-coded, Signals-ready inventory
- 18 counties never reviewed

## PROGRAM CONDITIONS THAT DRIVE THE RESTART

### SSI Phase I Updates

2018 to 2021 searches and rankings rescreened; sites lost, encroached, rezoned, or newly served

### Keep the inventory whole

18 counties, refreshed ownership and zoning

### SSI Portal licensing

Lapsed mid-2025; the system of record for RFI response

### Phase III, drafted, never run

No Indiana site advanced under the method

### Phase V and the national campaign

Site Profiles, NAICS brochures, Signals, SSI-Certified

# The response: a three-year Site Graduation Program in eight tracks

| | TRACK | SCOPE AND QUANTITY | DRIVER SERVED |
|---|---|---|---|
| A | **Complete and refresh the inventory** | 18 workshops; Phase I Updates; 490 sites refreshed | Region-led planning; inventory whole |
| F | **Data center model for smaller sites** | 25 to 150 acres on existing substation and fiber capacity | Data centers communities will accept |
| G | **Inactive Facility Revitalization for CIRDA** | Ten-county facility inventory, ranked | CIRDA; HEA 1406 |
| H | **SSI: Community for CIRDA** | Areas of opportunity in distressed communities | CIRDA; HEA 1406 |
| B | **Phase II preliminary due diligence** | 36 sites, weighted to priority sectors | Target industries |
| C | **Phase III site advancement for the REDOs and LEDOs** | 18 sites under purchase option; REDO training | Sites held, ready, marketable |
| D | **Target-industry technical marketing** | 490 NAICS codings; 100 profile sets; Signals-ready | Target industries; Phase V |
| E | **SSI Portal and program management** | Licenses, RFI support, quarterly reporting | Everyday RFI response |

Budget set in joint scoping at LDG unit rates. Cost share with the Power Partners on the NIPSCO 80/20 or 50/50 model. Procured competitively, with third-party due diligence and Audit and Finance review.

# CIRDA Sites: the inventory as the Catalyze Plan's product

**Catalyze needs competitive buildings and sites. SSI and IFRI provide the inventory. Branding and a county-by-county campaign turn it into product.**

1

### Pull and rescreen

Ten counties, 4.0+; 2021 rankings rescreened; Tipton's first workshop

2

### Align by NAICS

Catalyze sectors: human, animal, plant health; advanced manufacturing; logistics

3

### Map the ecosystem

Anchor campus, supplier park, logistics, R&D flex, facility reuse

4

### Qualify and designate

Phase II, site control, zoning; CIRDA Sites standard; HEA 1406 sites

5

### Ten county stories

Profile, brochure, StoryMap, and a narrative per county

6

### Run the campaign

Sector outreach, Signals matching, co-branded releases, credits attached

**Gives the plan its land and buildings**

The piece a tax credit cannot buy

**Feeds the HEA 1406 development plan**

An objective, ranked list CIRDA can adopt

**Reaches every member community**

Ten counties, ten stories, one brand

**Measurable in the state's terms**

Sites, RFIs, projects, wages at 125%

# A national marketing campaign built on the SSI Program

IEDC's 2023 release said Indiana leads the nation on strategic site identification. The claim has a 1,811-site, 92-county inventory behind it, and no other state can make it. A campaign converts that position into deal flow once sites graduate.

### The SSI-Certified Site mark

A published standard: ranked 4.0 or higher, Phase II complete, under site control, zoning-aligned. Each graduation announced as a named, documented product.

### Site selector and consultant outreach

Direct briefings to the consultants who report readiness as the number one elimination factor; Indiana's inventory presented as searchable, ranked, and controlled.

### Sector campaigns

Defense, life sciences, pharmaceuticals, data centers, and agbioscience, each with NAICS-coded Site Profiles and brochures matched to the sector's requirements.

### Demand matching with SSI: Signals

Expansion-intent intelligence matched to specific Indiana sites, so outreach goes to companies already moving, with the site attached.

### Co-branded with the partners

Power Partners, 15 regions, and the counties carry one message; an annual SSI Program Day at the Speedway restores the convening IEDC ran in 2022.

### An earned media cadence

LEAP as the precedent; graduation milestones, county wins, and Phase II completions released on a schedule, nationally and in trade press.

**What IEDC gets: national positioning as the one state with a complete, ranked, and controlled greenfield inventory, message discipline across eight utilities and 15 regions, and a marketing product that grows by six graduated sites a year. Delivered under Phase V, Track D, and the program management track.**

# Priorities, in order of dependency

## Immediate: first 60 days

- Renew the SSI Portal licenses
- Scope the eight tracks with IEDC and the Power Partners
- Respond to CIRDA's RFPQ
- Publish the Candidate Site Index; select year-one cohorts (12 Phase II, 6 Phase III)

## Near-term: months 3 to 6

- Run the 18 outstanding county workshops
- Start year-one Phase II and Phase III
- CIRDA facility inventory and SSI: Community baseline
- Data center model for smaller sites
- Begin NAICS coding of the 490

## 6 to 12 months

- SSI Phase I Updates for the earliest counties
- First 35 profile sets; connect the portal to SSI: Signals
- First Phase III cohort to site control
- Frame the national campaign and the CIRDA Sites standard
- First quarterly report in IEDC's terms

**First graduations within 12 to 15 months of restart. By year three: 18 graduated sites, 45 with Phase II, 490 coded and Signals-ready, all 92 counties ranked, the portal live.**

# Return on investment, and the cost of not continuing

## Invest

- 18 sites graduated under purchase option, the first controlled cohort outside LEAP
- CIRDA facility and neighborhood inventories behind the $1B initiative and HEA 1406
- A small-site data center inventory communities will host
- 490 sites NAICS-coded and Signals-ready; 100 profile sets
- All 92 counties ranked; the portal live for IEDC, eight utilities, 107 organizations

Seven years of program cost less than one mid-size incentive package. Reported quarterly: jobs and wages at the 125% standard, incentive dollars per job against $16,014.

## Do not continue

- The portal goes dark for IEDC, the utilities, and 107 local organizations
- Data from 2018 to 2021 decays; absorption unrechecked
- 18 counties stay invisible to RFI response
- Utilities and LEDOs reallocate; a restart becomes a rebuild
- Peer states convert inventories into product while Indiana's sits unadvanced

Rebuilding in 2029 costs more than the original, takes three to five years, and yields a weaker result. The head start is decisive for two to three years.

# Four decisions, in order or priority

1. **Authorize joint scoping**

   LDG and IEDC's site selection staff scope the eight tracks within 60 days; unit pricing from LDG; Power Partners invited to confirm cost share.

2. **Renew the SSI Portal licenses now**

   IEDC, the LEDO and REDO network, and the utilities, so the system of record is up during scoping.

3. **Support LDG's response to CIRDA's RFPQ**

   So the IFRI and SSI: Community tracks are scoped against the Catalyze Plan adopted in October 2026.

4. **Schedule the briefing**

   The inventory, the LEAP precedent, and the lead generation work that will draw on it, at the President's convenience.

## Indiana SSI Program 2.0

Site graduation to market while supporting key state initiatives and positioning REDOs and LEDOs with the real estate assets needed to attract industry targets.

**Victor Leotta**
*Director, Strategic Sites*
Location Design Group, LLC
(225) 281-4202
victor@location-design.com